

Survey on Short Videos & Chinese Culture

Thank you for your contribution.

This is a survey on short videos' worldwide impact on Contemporary Chinese Culture in the aspect of popularization and communication, conducted by a team from Beijing Foreign Studies University. If you are interested in taking further parts, feel free to contact us at john.wuyusen@gmail.com.



* 必答题

Basic information

1. Please choose your identity of your sexuality. *

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Non-binary

2. Would you love to accept our offer for a 30-minutes online interview with a payment of US\$25? *

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

3. Please give us the email to contact you.

4. Which continent are you from? *

- ☐ North America
- ☐ Europe
- ☐ Asia
- ☐ Oceania
- ☐ South America
- ☐ Africa

Attraction

This part tries to answer whether Chinese short videos catch your eyes at the first sights.

5. When you are quickly scrolling through the short videos, how visually striking do you find those about Chinese culture? Does the "exotic" nature of Chinese cultural elements (e.g. calligraphy) make you more curious to watch than contents from your own culture?
- ☐ Much More Attractive: Yes, the "difference" is exactly why I watch; I love seeing something new.
 - ☐ More Attractive: It catches my eye more than standard local content.
 - ☐ Neutral: It attracts me about the same as any other interesting video.
 - ☐ Less Attractive: I prefer watching content I am familiar with and understand easily.
 - ☐ Discouraging: The unfamiliarity makes me skip it because I don't understand it.
6. Even without understanding the language, how often does the background music or traditional sound effect (e.g. Guqin, nature sounds) compel you to stay and watch?
- ☐ Always: The music/sound creates a vibe that keeps me watching.
 - ☐ Often: Good audio frequently helps grab my attention.
 - ☐ Sometimes: Occasionally, if the music is particularly catchy or relaxing.
 - ☐ Rarely: I usually watch videos on mute or don't care about the audio.
 - ☐ Never: The sound has no effect on my decision to watch.
7. Do large-scale traditional Chinese cultural displays (e.g., Dragon Dances, Lantern Festivals) create a visual shock that forces you to stop scrolling?
- ☐ Always: The scale and color are visually shocking and irresistible.
 - ☐ Often: I usually stop to see what is happening.
 - ☐ Sometimes: If the colors or music are particularly striking.
 - ☐ Rarely: I've seen them before, so I might skip.
 - ☐ Never: These types of cultural performances don't interest me.

8. Does the futuristic visual of modern Chinese cities (e.g., Chongqing's monorails, Shanghai's night skyline) attract you more than standard travel vlogs?

- ☐ Much More: Yes, the "Cyberpunk" vibe is a huge visual hook for me.
- ☐ More: It is more eye-catching than typical city views.
- ☐ Neutral: It attracts me about the same as any big city video.
- ☐ Less: I prefer seeing nature or rural sides of China, not cities.
- ☐ Never: I don't care about city scenery videos.

Resonance

This part tries to figure out: whether the Chinese short videos you watched actually moved you, struck a chord with you, or made you go "hey, that's just like me"?

9. When watching Chinese short videos, have you ever been "moved" by certain scenes or stories? (e.g. seeing ordinary people chase their dreams, or family reunions that warm your heart or make you emotional)

- ☐ Quite frequently (>7/10)
- ☐ Frequently (5~7/10)
- ☐ Often (3~4/10)
- ☐ Sometimes (1~2/10)
- ☐ Never (0/10)

10. Have some short videos broken your previous stereotypes about China? (For example, thinking it was all "traditional" before, but later discovering it's actually "modern"; or thinking it felt "distant" before, but later finding it "real") *

- ☐ Enormously
- ☐ Considerably
- ☐ Moderately
- ☐ A little bit
- ☐ Not at all

11. Do you often find some values from these short videos of Chinese Culture to be universal or striking a chord with you? (Like family love, personal struggle, harmony between humans and nature—you can pick more than one) *

- ☐ Quite frequently (>7/10)
- ☐ Frequently (5~7/10)
- ☐ Often (3~4/10)
- ☐ Sometimes (1~2/10)
- ☐ Never (0/10)

12. Have the lifestyles shown in the videos (like exploring small towns, learning a craft, urban adventures) made you think about your own plans? (Such as academic direction or Gap Year ideas)

- ☐ Gave me a lot of inspiration
- ☐ Often think about it
- ☐ Sometimes thought about it
- ☐ Rarely thought about it
- ☐ Never thought about it

13. If a person or event in a video about Chinese culture really left an impression on you, would you want to search for more stories behind it?

- ☐ Definitely will search
- ☐ Probably well
- ☐ It depends
- ☐ Probably won't
- ☐ Definitely won't

Retention

This part tries to figure out whether short videos in Chinese culture is "sticky" in the long run.

14. After watching an interesting short video about Chinese culture, do you click on the creator's avatar to visit their profile and watch more videos?

- ☐ Quite frequently (>7/10)
- ☐ Frequently (5~7/10)
- ☐ Often (3~4/10)
- ☐ Sometimes (1~2/10)
- ☐ Never (0/10)

15. How frequently do you share short videos related to Chinese culture with friends or post them on your social media?

- ☐ Very Frequently: >5 times a week.
- ☐ Frequently: 3-5 times a week.
- ☐ Moderately: About 1-3 times a week.
- ☐ Rarely: Almost never, unless it is extremely special.
- ☐ Never: I never share this type of content.

16. If a Chinese creator you like hasn't appeared in your feed for a while, would you actively search for their name to check for updates?

- ☐ Definitely: I would be worried I missed their updates.
- ☐ Likely: If I suddenly remember their content.
- ☐ Neutral: Hard to say; I might if I recall them.
- ☐ Unlikely: I usually only consume what appears on my "For You" page.
- ☐ Definitely Not: If I forget them, I forget them.

17. Do you leave comments or read the comment section to understand more about the cultural background?

- ☐ Very Actively: I always read comments and frequently participate in discussions.
- ☐ Actively: I often read comments and occasionally like or reply.
- ☐ Moderately: I only read the top comments and do not interact.
- ☐ Passively: I rarely look at the comments; I focus only on the video.
- ☐ None: I almost never look at the comment section.

18. Would you turn on "Post Notifications" (the bell icon) to keep up with a Chinese creator? Yes, Certainly: I don't want to miss any updates.

- ☐ Yes, Certainly: I don't want to miss any updates.
- ☐ Maybe: Only for a very small number of my absolute favorite creators.
- ☐ Neutral: I'm not sure; I generally don't turn on notifications.
- ☐ Probably Not: I don't think it's necessary.
- ☐ No: Absolutely not; it would annoy me.

Conversion

This part tries to answer whether short videos of Chinese culture changed your life and made you want to take actions to engage in Chinese culture.

19. After watching a video about Chinese culture, do you actively search for specific keywords mentioned (e.g., place names, historical events, dish names) on Google, Wikipedia, or other platforms?

- ☐ Always: I have a strong curiosity to learn more details.
- ☐ Often: Especially when I encounter concepts I don't understand.
- ☐ Sometimes: If the specific topic is very interesting.
- ☐ Rarely: I just watch and move on.
- ☐ Never: The information in the video is enough.

20. Have you ever purchased Chinese-related products (e.g., snacks, Hanfu, electronics, game skins) because you saw them in a short video?

- ☐ Very Frequently: Purchased more than 10 times; video recommendations influence me greatly.
- ☐ Frequently: Purchased 3~9 times; I've had a few pleasant shopping experiences.
- ☐ Tried: I have tried purchasing 1 or 2 times.
- ☐ Considered: Thought about buying, but never actually placed an order.
- ☐ Never: I have never had the thought of purchasing.

21. Have you attempted to practice or imitate content from the Chinese culture videos (e.g., trying a Chinese recipe, using a Chinese phrase, attempting Chinese-style makeup/crafts)?

- ☐ Frequently: I have mastered several new skills/words.
- ☐ Sometimes: I have tried a few times; it's fun.
- ☐ Once or Twice: Tried once or twice, but didn't persist.
- ☐ Mentally Only: Thought about trying, but never took action.
- ☐ Never: Never thought about imitating.

22. Have you downloaded Chinese local social apps (e.g. Rednote/Xiaohongshu, Douyin, WeChat, Bilibili) to see more authentic content?

- ☐ Yes, Use Daily: Downloaded and I use them frequently.
- ☐ Yes, Keep It: Downloaded and I open them occasionally.
- ☐ Tried: Downloaded, but uninstalled due to language barriers or other problems met.
- ☐ Curious: Wanted to download, but haven't acted yet.
- ☐ Not Curious and Never Downloaded Any.

23. Have these videos prompted you to take action offline (e.g., visiting a local Chinatown, eating at a Chinese restaurant, attending a cultural festival)?

- ☐ Strong Action: Yes, I frequently go out of my way to experience things mentioned in videos.
- ☐ Action: Yes, I have gone a few times.
- ☐ Coincidence: I have gone, but it was just a coincidence, not purely because of the videos.
- ☐ Plan: Haven't gone yet, but it's on my plan list.
- ☐ No: Video content does not affect my offline life.

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